

A Secondary School for Value Creation

An evidence-grounded reconstruction of Daisaku Ikeda’s educational philosophy: rigorous learning directed toward student happiness, human dignity, peace and contribution.

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Evidence code **IKEDA** directly grounded in Ikeda’s stated philosophy **PRACTICE** documented Soka-school precedent

PROPOSAL this handout’s concrete reconstruction

IKEDA “The fundamental task of education must be to ensure that knowledge serves to further the cause of human happiness and peace.” —Teachers College lecture, 1996 [1]

THE NORTH STAR

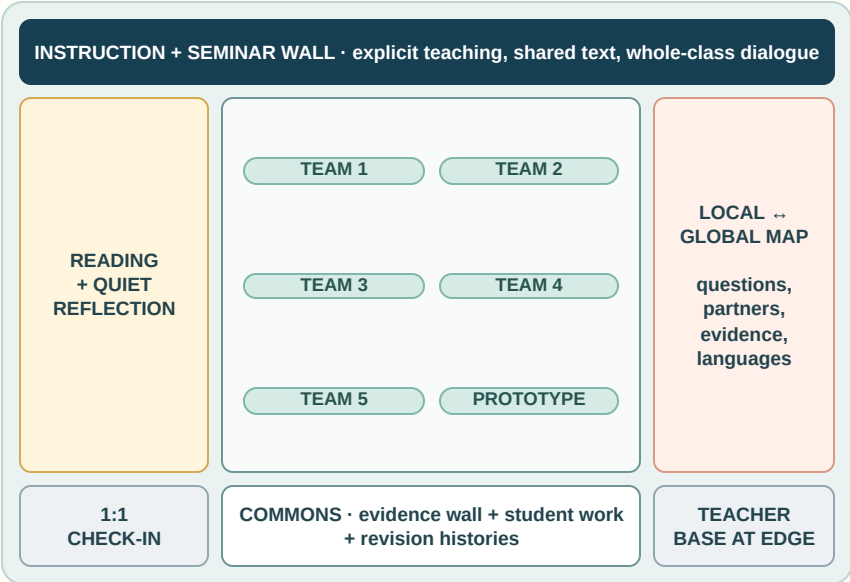
Purpose · happiness
Not constant comfort: the lifelong capacity to create meaning, benefit oneself and contribute to others.

Method · dialogue
Teacher and learner develop through trust, questioning, listening and mutual growth—not one-way transmission.

Intellect · wisdom
Knowledge remains indispensable; students learn to direct it with judgment, responsibility and humane purpose.

Horizon · citizenship
Wisdom to see interdependence, courage to meet difference, compassion that reaches beyond proximity.

PROPOSAL THE IDEAL CLASSROOM



Movable furniture supports direct instruction, seminar and inquiry. The teacher remains intellectually active and relationally present; the desk is not a throne. Original schematic—not an official Soka layout.

DESIGN INVARIANTS

- **Every learner is known.** An advisor tracks strengths, concerns and growth.
- **High care + high challenge.** Belief in potential never means lowering standards.
- **Knowledge has a destination.** Lessons ask what learning enables us to understand, create or repair.
- **Difference is educative.** Disagreement is examined, not feared or forced into consensus.
- **The local community is a text.** Nearby realities open onto global interdependence.
- **Beauty matters.** Literature, art, music, craft and well-made work cultivate sensibility.

Looks like
annotated texts, models, data, student revisions, mixed modes of participation

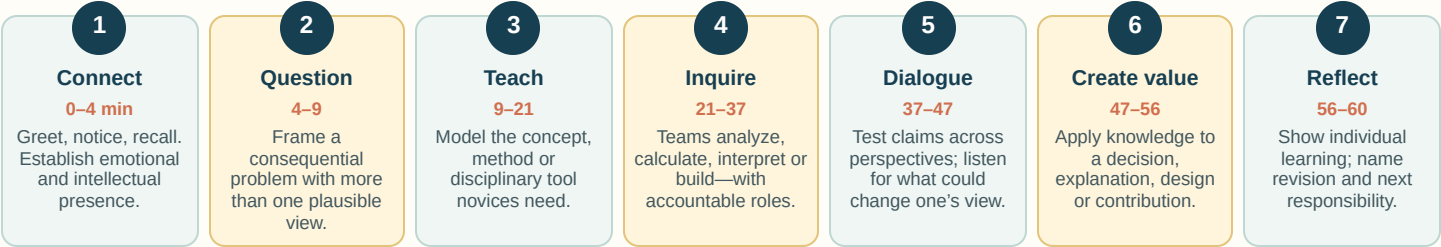
Sounds like
precise explanation, genuine questions, evidence-based dissent, encouragement

Feels like
dignity, intellectual seriousness, productive struggle, belonging without conformity

THE LESSON

A 60-minute value-creating lesson

Dialogue does not replace subject teaching. The cycle moves from human connection to explicit disciplinary knowledge, inquiry, encounter with difference, useful action and reflective self-revision.



PROPOSAL Time is a design constraint, not doctrine. Shorter or longer blocks can preserve the same intellectual arc.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MATHEMATICS + ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCE

Driving question: Can our school cut lunchtime food waste by 40% without reducing nutrition or shifting cost unfairly?

Learning: percentage change, sampling error, proportional reasoning, material flows, stakeholder trade-offs. **Product:** a quantified 1-page proposal for the cafeteria team.

Time	Teacher move	Student evidence
0–4	Connect	Privately estimate yesterday's waste from a photograph; pair-check assumptions.
4–9	Question	Identify who is affected: diners, staff, growers, budget holders, landfill neighbors.
9–21	Teach precisely	Follow a worked example; distinguish 40 percentage points from a 40% reduction; critique a biased sample.
21–37	Coach inquiry	Calculate a baseline and confidence limits from a supplied 10-day dataset; compare two interventions.
37–47	Structure dialogue	Use stakeholder roles; make a claim, cite data, restate a contrary view fairly, then respond.
47–56	Demand usefulness	Select one action, quantify expected impact and cost, state one risk and a 2-week test.
56–60	Make learning visible	Exit slip: one corrected calculation, one view changed by evidence, one unresolved question.

DIALOGUE PROTOCOL

- Claim:** "Our evidence suggests..."
- Listen:** "I hear your concern is..."
- Test:** "What would count against our view?"
- Bridge:** "We agree on...; we differ on..."
- Revise:** "I now think... because..."

No forced consensus. Courage includes respectful disagreement; wisdom includes changing one's mind.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- Mathematics is accurate and units are clear.
- Evidence and uncertainty are distinguished.
- A competing view is represented fairly.
- The proposal creates plausible personal and social benefit.
- The student can name what they revised.

TEACHER'S CLOSING QUESTION

"What can this knowledge now help us do wisely—here, with the people actually affected?"

High challenge, high care, shared growth

IKEDA The humanity of the teacher is central, and trust begins with the teacher's belief in students. **PRACTICE** Tokyo Soka High School names human capacity, dialogue, intellect and social capacity among its aims. [2, 5]

1 Know the learner; earn trust

Use names, interests, work history and regular 1:1 check-ins. Encourage specifically. Maintain professional boundaries; never make care performative.

2 Teach the discipline explicitly

State the concept, model expert thinking, check understanding, then release responsibility. Humanism is not intellectual vagueness.

3 Design real dialogue

Use rich questions, preparation time, evidence, turn structures and metacognitive reflection. Invite dissent; intervene when dignity or facts are attacked.

4 Make cooperation accountable

Assign roles that rotate—facilitator, skeptic, analyst, connector. Require both a shared product and individual evidence of understanding.

5 Link local and global

Begin with a nearby system, person or place; trace its connections to human rights, peace, environment and development. Return to feasible local action.

6 Normalize revision

Give feedback on the next move. Preserve drafts and reflection. Praise courage, accuracy and improvement—not compliance or a fixed “good student” identity.

PROPOSAL ASSESSMENT THROUGH FOUR LENSES

Mastery

accurate knowledge, technique, vocabulary

Reasoning

evidence, inference, uncertainty, critique

Dialogue

listening, fair representation, constructive response

Application

usefulness, consequence, revision, transfer

Guardrail: grade observable work—not beliefs, personality, agreeableness, religious identity or extroversion. Subject mastery remains non-negotiable; schools set weights by course and task.

PLAN EVERY LESSON WITH 6 QUESTIONS

1. What exact disciplinary knowledge must students gain?
2. Why could this matter to human life or the world?
3. What will I explain or model directly?
4. Where will students encounter a meaningful difference?
5. What will they create, decide, explain or improve?
6. What individual evidence will prove learning?

RESTORATIVE DISCIPLINE WITH BOUNDARIES

Dignity forbids humiliation; it does not forbid consequences. Protect safety first, establish facts, hear impact, require repair and support a return to learning.

Protect
stop
harm

Understand
facts +
needs

Repair
make
amends

Rejoin
restore
trust

THE TEACHER'S DAY-TO-DAY CRAFT

- Greet students at the threshold.
- Scan who is silent, absent or thriving.
- Teach one idea with exceptional clarity.
- Ask a question whose answer is not staged.
- Confer with one learner about their work.
- Record one actionable observation.
- Exchange evidence with a colleague.
- Reflect: “What did students teach me?”

Mutual growth does not erase adult responsibility: the teacher still protects standards, time, truth and safety.

Rhythm, culture and guardrails

PRACTICE Tokyo Soka High School documents morning reading/homeroom, six periods, lunch, cleaning and clubs. The timetable below is a transferable 5-block reconstruction—not a report of the current school day. [6, 7]

PROPOSAL A SAMPLE DAY

08:20–08:40	Advisory + reading. Quiet reading, check-in, one purpose for the day; scheduled individual conferences.
08:45–09:45	Core 1. Language / humanities: close reading, writing, seminar.
09:55–10:55	Core 2. Mathematics: explicit modeling, practice, application.
11:05–12:05	Core 3. Science: investigation, explanation, evidence.
12:05–13:00	Lunch + community. Unhurried meal, peer life, optional clubs or support.
13:00–14:00	Core 4. Social studies / languages: local-global inquiry and dialogue.
14:10–15:10	Core 5 / studio. Arts, physical education, technology or interdisciplinary project.
15:10–15:25	Care for place. Shared cleanup, reset resources, practical stewardship—not punishment.
15:25–16:20	Clubs / tutorial / exhibition. Student leadership, practice, mentoring and public work.

THE PEOPLE SYSTEM

- **Advisory:** 12–16 students; one adult stays with the group for multiple years where possible.
- **Protected teacher learning:** 2 common planning periods weekly; examine student work, not impressions.
- **Family connection:** communicate strengths before problems; invite knowledge and language from home.
- **Community partners:** co-design questions and receive useful products; service is reciprocal, not charity theatre.
- **Student voice:** real input on routines, projects and climate—within transparent adult responsibility.

MONTHLY / TERMLY PULSE

Monthly: public dialogue or arts event; local fieldwork; advisor review of belonging and progress.

Each term: exhibition of rigorous work; student-led reflection; community partner feedback; faculty study of who is flourishing and who is not.

A WEEKLY LEARNING RHYTHM

MON · PURPOSE

Launch consequential questions; diagnose knowledge; locate the human stakes.

TUE · KNOWLEDGE

Build disciplinary concepts, vocabulary and techniques through explicit teaching.

WED · INQUIRY

Investigate, calculate, read, experiment and critique evidence with others.

THU · APPLICATION

Fieldwork, design, cross-cultural encounter or problem-solving with a real audience.

FRI · CONTRIBUTION

Share, receive critique, revise, reflect and decide the next responsibility.

GUARDRAILS AGAINST DISTORTION

- ✓ No doctrinal teaching, worship or personality cult.
- ✓ No forced harmony or suppression of dissent.
- ✓ No “happiness” used to deny grief or struggle.
- ✓ No dialogue used as a substitute for evidence.
- ✓ No care without boundaries or safeguarding.
- ✓ No service that exploits students or communities.

IKEDA Ikeda stated that education does not exist for religion; recent scholarship describes his human education as secular and explicitly rejects proselytization in schooling. [2, 4]

SOURCES AND RECONSTRUCTION NOTE

[1] D. Ikeda, “Thoughts on Education for Global Citizenship,” Teachers College, 1996.

daisakuikeda.org/.../lect-08

[2] “Soka Education in Practice.” daisakuikeda.org/.../edu-04

[3] Ikeda Center, “Four Aspects of Daisaku Ikeda’s Education Philosophy.” ikedacenter.org/resources/...

[4] J. Goulah & R. Kartha, “Wisdom and Contemplative Effort...,” *Journal of Contemplative & Holistic Education*, 2026. doi:10.25035/jche.03.02.09

[5] Tokyo Soka High School, curriculum and four capacities. tokyo-senior.soka.ed.jp/study/curriculum

[6] Tokyo Soka High School, Global Citizenship Project report, 2020. tokyo-senior.soka.ed.jp/news/.../2814

[7] Tokyo Soka High School, “A day at Soka High School.” tokyo-senior.soka.ed.jp/life/time

Interpretive limit: Ikeda left a philosophy and institutional precedents, not one compulsory classroom layout, lesson sequence or timetable. All items tagged PROPOSAL translate principles into a plausible contemporary secondary-school model and should be tested locally.